

Argumentative Essay Outline (Claim)

Directions: Use this outline as a “road map” to write your essay. If you need more examples or sentence starters, use page 2 to help you!

1) Introduction/Claim (One paragraph)

- Start with a hook or attention getting sentence.
- Briefly summarize the texts
- State your claim. Make sure you are restating the prompt.

2) Body Paragraph: Evidence/Support/Warrant

- Include a topic sentence that restates your claim and your reason.
 - **Example: Video games are harmful because**_____.
- Include text evidence that supports your reason.
 - **Example: The author shows that video games are harmful because in paragraph 2 it states**_____
- Include an explanation (warrant) that shows how your text evidence proved your claim.
 - **Example: The author uses this evidence to show how/that**_____.

3) Body Paragraph: Evidence/Support/Warrant

- Include a topic sentence that restates your claim and your reason.
 - **Example: Video games are harmful because**_____.
- Include text evidence that supports your reason.
 - **Example: The author shows that video games are harmful because in paragraph 2 it states**_____
- Include an explanation (warrant) that shows how your text evidence proved your claim.
 - **Example: The author uses this evidence to show how/that**_____.

4) Counterclaim Paragraph:

- Explain what others who don't agree with your claim might say.
 - **Example: Some people might disagree. They may believe**_____ **because**_____.

5) Conclusion (One paragraph)

- Restate your claim and summarize your reasoning.
 - **Example: In conclusion, the text shows that videogames are harmful by pointing out that**_____

Additional Examples and Sentence Starters

I. INTRO-PARAGRAPH

A. HOOK CHOOSE ONE

B. EXPLAIN the ISSUE

- Explain the issue.
- Introduce the issue that your essay will be about before you state your thesis.
- Why is it an issue?
- Why is it a problem or controversy?

C. CLAIM or THESIS Parts

- Subject: What is the subject you are arguing about.
- What's the argument?: What are you arguing about that subject? Be specific!
- 3 points: 3 points of support for your argument

Types of Hook Sentences:

- Grab the reader's attention with a thought
- Rhetorical Question– a question with an answer.
- Anecdote– a short story.
- Quotation– a line from a source.

Explain sentence starter:

- The issue of _____ is a complex one. It's about....
- The controversy is: _____

Claim Sentence Starters

- I observed _____ when _____.
- I compared _____ and _____.
- I noticed _____, when _____.

II. Body paragraph(s) S.E.E. (2-3) III. Paragraphs Depending on the number of Selections!

A. S....STATEMENT

- TTQAA
- TOPIC SENTENCES

(INTRODUCES EVIDENCE = SUPPORTS CLAIM)

B. E....EVIDENCE (Data)

- PICK AND USE AN EVIDENCE SENTENCE STARTER.
- WRITE A QUOTE from the text is relevant & supports your CLAIM. PUT QUOTES AROUND YOUR QUOTE
- YOU MUST HAVE QUOTATION MARKS "..."
- TITLE OF THE BOOK BEHIND THE QUOTE
- THE PAGE # OR PARAGRAPH

C. E....EXPLAIN

- HOW DOES THE EVIDENCE SUPPORTS THE CLAIM?
- WARRANT/REASON

Topic Sentence Starters

Turn the question or Prompt around (Restate) and answer it.

- A reason why (your main claim) is true because (state your argument).
- (state your argument) demonstrates that (main claim) is true.

Evidence Sentence Starters

- According to the text...
- The author wrote...
- In the ____, paragraph the author stated....
- On page ____, the author stated...
- As the author mentioned on page____

Explain/Warrant/Reason Sentence Starters

- This evidence illustrates ...,because...
- This conveys
- As a rule
- This suggests

IV. Counter-Claim Paragraph : Argument Essays must have a Counter-Claim!!!

A. COUNTER-CLAIM

- PICK AND USE A COUNTER-CLAIM SENTENCE STARTER.

B. Explain

- Why the Counter-claim argument is weak.

Counter-claim Sentence Starters

- People who disagree may claim that "State the opposing side's opposite claim"...
- Critics may claim that "state the opposing side's claim"...

Explain Counter-claim Sentence Starters

- This argument is weak because...
- On the contrary.....

V. Conclusion

- A. Restatement of the Claim (Different words)
- B. A summary of the evidence provided
- C. Leave the reader with something to think about, a question, or something to do.